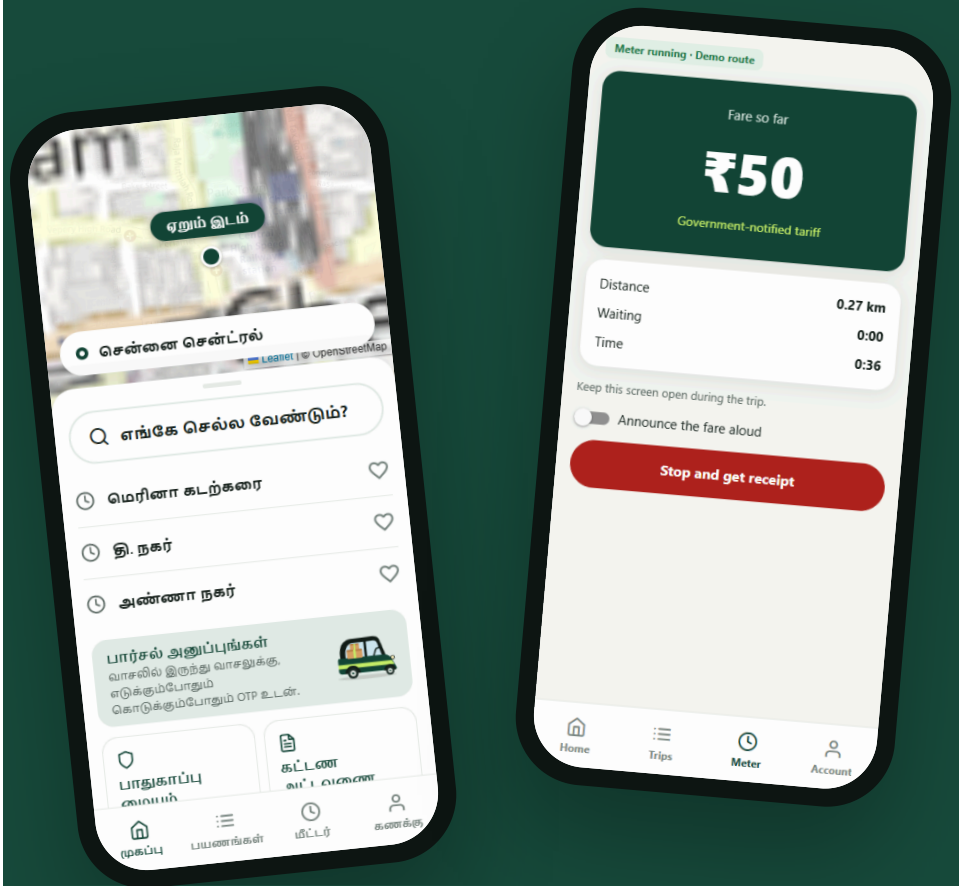
PROPOSAL TO THE GOVERNMENT OF TAMIL NADU

Fair fares for every ride. One honest meter for all of Tamil Nadu.

தோழன் · நம் நகரம். நம் மக்கள். நம் பயணம்.

Thozhan is a citizen-led, Tamil-first mobility platform for autos, authorised bike services, cabs and parcel delivery. At its heart is a **government-configurable digital auto meter**. It works for app bookings and street hails, and gives the passenger and the driver the same itemised receipt.

Government-notified tariff · No surge pricing · ₹10 a day, zero commission · Tamil first · Working Android app



30 min

Our request: one meeting

A 30-minute presentation to the appropriate officers of CUMTA, the Transport and Road Safety Department, the Transport Commissionerate, TNeGA, the Gig Workers Welfare Board, the Finance Department and the Police and emergency-response teams.

WHY IT MATTERS

Everyday travel should not start with an argument

Passengers, drivers and the Government all lose when fares are unclear and data is locked inside private platforms.

Fare disputes

Street-hail fares are often negotiated instead of metered, even when the Government has notified a tariff.

Unpredictable prices

App fares can rise with demand-based surge pricing that is not part of any approved tariff.

Commission on drivers

Percentage commissions reduce what drivers take home on every single trip.

No public data

Planners get little reliable, privacy-safe evidence about how people actually move.

THE CENTRAL FEATURE

A digital auto meter the Government controls

The Government sets the tariff once; Thozhan applies it to every trip, booked or hailed on the street. It records the approved tariff, distance, waiting time and fare rules, and prints the same receipt for passenger and driver. Try it with the current notified auto tariff:

Trip distance 5.0 km

Waiting time 3 min

☐ Night trip (10 pm – 5 am, 1.5×)

- Works for app bookings **and** street-hail trips
- Tariff changes are made centrally, effective from the date in the order
- GPS distance measured on the phone and checked on the server
- Passengers can report an overcharge from the receipt

Receipt · same for passenger and driver

₹133

Government-notified tariff

Minimum fare (first 1.8 km)	₹50.00
Additional distance (3.2 km × ₹25)	₹80.00
Waiting (3 min × ₹1)	₹3.00
Total fare	**₹133**

Source: G.O. Ms. No. 366, Home (Transport-I) Department, 27.10.2026. Minimum fare ₹50 for the first 1.8 km, then ₹25 per km; waiting ₹1 per minute; night 1.5×. Rounded to the nearest rupee (rounding rule to be confirmed with the Department).

WHO BENEFITS

Good for passengers, drivers and the Government

For passengers

The legal fare, every time

Fares follow the notified tariff with no unapproved surge. The price is shown before booking.

Itemised receipt

Base fare, distance, waiting and night charge, with the Government order quoted on the receipt.

Safety at every step

Trip OTP, number-plate check, SOS, 112 and 181 shortcuts, trusted contacts and live trip sharing.

Tamil first

Every screen in Tamil and English, large touch targets and screen-reader labels.

Meter for street hails

Stopped an auto on the road? Start the meter in the app and get the same fair receipt.

Complaints that close

Overcharge, lost-item and safety reports get a reference number and are tracked to resolution.

For drivers

Keep what you earn

Thozhan proposes a flat ₹10 platform charge, only after the driver's first completed eligible trip of the day. No commission. No charge on days with no trips. Passengers pay the driver directly by cash or UPI.

Fares collected per day ₹1,500



Working days per month 25



Commission rate to compare 20%



Percentage commission
₹7,500
per month

Thozhan day charge
₹250
per month

Driver keeps an extra
₹7,250
per month, per driver. Illustrative: commission rates differ between platforms.

Clear earnings records

Daily earnings, a fee ledger and 7 / 30-day summaries, ready for loans and welfare schemes.

Driver safety too

Verified passengers, trip OTP, SOS and a fair process for complaints and ratings.

Simple paperwork

Document upload with expiry reminders, so renewals are never missed.

Optional insurance

Access to cover through a licensed insurer, never sold by Thozhan itself.

For the Government

Tariff policy that is enforced

Notified fares are applied automatically on every trip. A new order is configured once and takes effect statewide.

Privacy-safe mobility data

Aggregated demand, trip times, fare accuracy and complaint statistics for CUMTA planning, with no personal details shared.

Support for gig workers

Transparent earnings records that can help with welfare-board registration and benefits.

Faster emergency response

SOS with trip, vehicle and location details, ready to connect to 112 and the police if approved.

Possible revenue

A share of platform charges, if a public-private arrangement is agreed. See the planning calculator below.

Audit and accountability

Every fare, fee and admin action is recorded with an audit trail that the Government can inspect.

Revenue planning scenario

Simple arithmetic to support discussion. This is not an income forecast and no revenue share has been agreed.

Active drivers **10,000**

Paid days per month **22**

Government share, if agreed **10%**

Platform charges per month

₹22.0 lakh

Platform charges per year

₹2.64 crore

Government share per year

₹26.4 lakh

Before costs and taxes. Running costs (servers, SMS, maps, support, insurance administration) are paid from platform charges.

NOT JUST AN IDEA

Already designed, built and tested

A working Android app, a backend and an operations dashboard exist today. The screens below are from the real app, in English and Tamil.

80

designed mobile screens for passengers and drivers

2

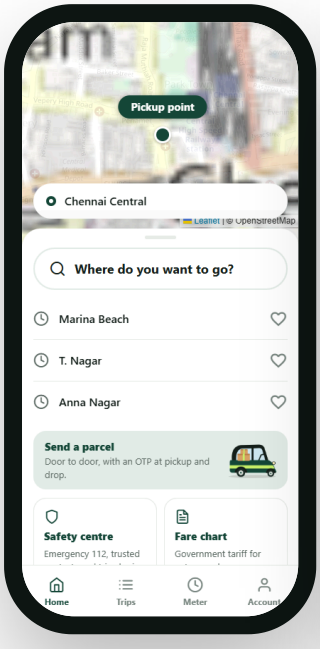
languages on every screen: Tamil and English

83

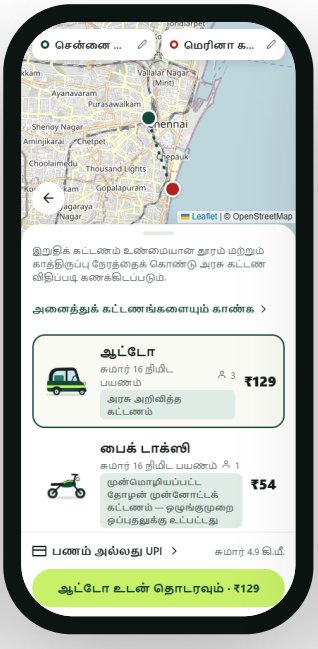
automated backend and fare tests, all passing

1

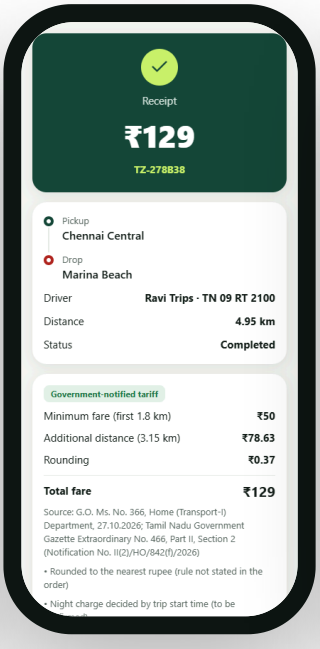
physical Android phone with the full trip flow tested



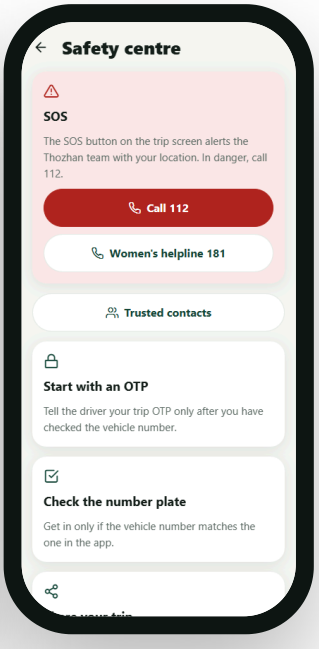
Passenger home



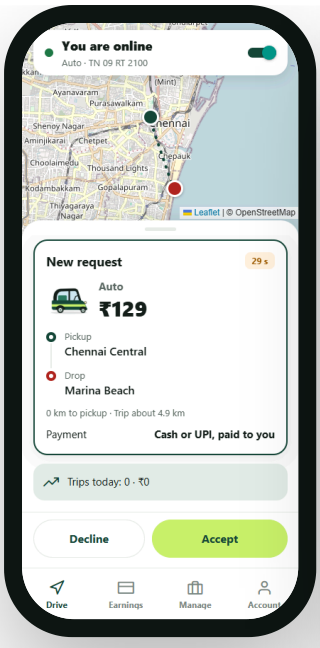
Vehicle choice in Tamil



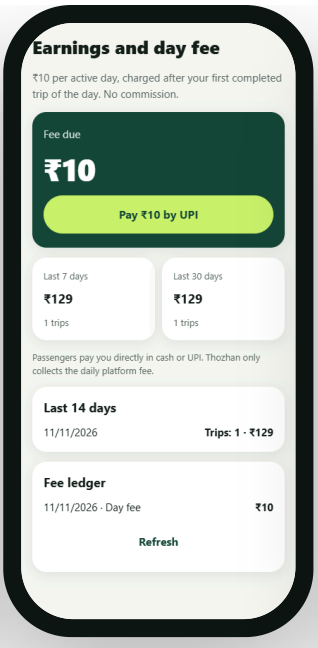
Itemised receipt



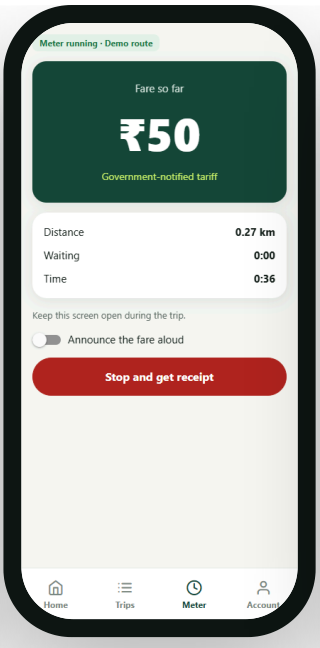
Safety centre



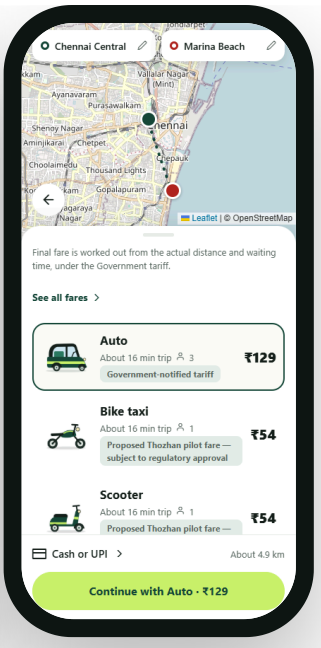
Driver trip request



₹10 day fee, no commission



Street-hail meter



Autos, bikes, cabs, parcels

Complete UX prototype

All 80 passenger and driver screens, clickable.

https://mukesh-areo.github.io/Thozhan/ux/

Open the prototype →

Interactive web demo

Book a ride, run the meter and see the driver side, in Tamil and English.

https://mukesh-areo.github.io/Thozhan/demo/

Open the demo →

Source code

App, backend, tests and documentation, open for review.

github.com/Mukesh-areo/Thozhan

View on GitHub →

SERVICES AND SAFEGUARDS

Every service only with the right approval

Services

Auto (booked and street hail)	Notified tariff
Bike taxi and scooter	Subject to approval
Cab	Subject to approval
Parcel delivery (bike and auto)	Subject to approval

Only autos would run in the first pilot. Each other service can be switched on centrally, only after the Government approves it and its fares.

Safeguards built in

- Driver documents and vehicle verified before going online
- Trip OTP and number-plate check before every ride
- Parcel declaration and photos at pickup and delivery
- Personal data minimised; passengers can download or delete their data
- Complete audit trail of fares, fees and admin decisions

PROPOSED PILOT

Start small, measure honestly, then decide

A bounded Chennai auto pilot, with results published against an agreed baseline before any expansion.

1

PHASE 0

Approvals

Nodal officer, tariff and licence clarity, security review, driver consultation.

2

PHASE 1

Closed pilot

50–150 verified auto drivers in one service area, with staffed support and incident handling.

3

PHASE 2

Measure and publish

Fare accuracy, pickup times, driver take-home pay, complaints resolved, accessibility.

4

PHASE 3

Expand if approved

More areas and services only after an independent review.

GOVERNMENT SUPPORT NEEDED

What we respectfully request

Thozhan cannot succeed as a private app alone. A fair public meter needs the Government's guidance and backing.

CUMTA

Guidance on the pilot area, integration with public transport, and use of aggregated mobility data.

Transport and Road Safety Department

Confirmation of how the notified auto tariff applies to the digital meter, aggregator requirements, and policy for bike and cab services.

Transport Commissionerate

A process to verify driver licences, permits and vehicle documents.

TNeGA

Hosting, data-protection and security-audit guidance, and possible e-governance integration.

Labour Welfare and Gig Workers Welfare Board

Linking drivers' earnings records to welfare registration and benefits.

Finance Department

Review of the ₹10 platform charge, revenue-share options and the pilot budget.

Police and emergency response

Connecting the SOS feature to 112 and women's helpline 181 workflows.

A nodal officer

One point of contact to coordinate departments and approve a defined pilot.

TRANSPARENCY

Current limitations

- **Not yet in public service.** The app has been tested on a test server and a real phone, not with live passengers.
- **Approvals pending.** Bike, scooter, cab and parcel fares are proposals until approved.
- **Tariff details to confirm.** Rounding and night-charge rules need confirmation from the Department.

- **Figures are scenarios.** Revenue and savings numbers are planning arithmetic, not guaranteed outcomes.
- **Insurance** would be offered only through a licensed insurer.
- **Before launch:** security audit, production hosting, SMS registration and staffed support are still required.

நம் நகரம். நம் மக்கள். நம் பயணம்.

Let's build fair mobility for Tamil Nadu together

We request 30 minutes to present Thozhan to the appropriate officers.

Proposed by **Mukesh**, independent developer, Thirunindravur, Tamil Nadu

Thozhan · தோழன் · A citizen-led proposal. Not endorsed by or affiliated with the Government of Tamil Nadu.

Online version: https://mukesh-areo.github.io/Thozhan/